KOR STRUCTURAL · PREPARED FOR MVE + PARTNERS · 27 AUGUST 2026

Arizona has no incumbent architect. Raleigh has one, and it just changed hands.

You asked for the Arizona submitted-projects search. It is in here, out of the city's own records. But the list is not the valuable part — the valuable part is what fifty Arizona projects say when you count them properly, and what happens when the same measurement is run on a second market.

`Arizona: 12 projects, 11 firms` `Raleigh: 11 projects, 7 firms` `Top firm: 17% vs 36%`

START HERE

Arizona multifamily has no incumbent architect

Twelve multifamily projects. Eleven different architecture firms. One firm has two of them and nobody has three.

The set is *50 commercial real estate projects to know in 2026*, published by AZ Big Media. It names a design team on 49 of the 50 — developer, architect and general contractor per project. We took every one of those labelled fields and counted them, which turns out to be a different exercise from reading the list.

Twenty-four per cent of it is multifamily. Thirty-four per cent is civic and education, twenty per cent industrial, twelve healthcare, ten hospitality. So the first honest thing to say about an "Arizona projects" list is that three-quarters of it is not your market at all. The twelve that are look like this:

ARCHITECT	ARIZONA MULTIFAMILY PROJECTS
Gensler	**2**
triARC architecture & design	1
Niles Bolton Associates	1
KTGY	1
Dig Studio	1
ESG Architecture & Design	1
LGE Design Build	1
Lamar Johnson Collaborative	1
GFF Design	1
Athena Studio	1
Soaring Eight	1

▲ WHAT THAT ACTUALLY MEANS

In a consolidated market the top firm holds a third or more and the pitch is a displacement argument — you have to take work off somebody. **Here the largest holder of Arizona multifamily work in the set has two projects out of twelve.** There is no incumbent to displace, because there is no incumbent. A firm entering this market is not fighting a share war; it is walking into a field where nobody has established one.

The national multifamily names are present but thin on the ground — **KTGY, Niles Bolton and ESG have one project each.** They are in Arizona. They have not taken it.

WE TESTED IT

The same measurement in Raleigh gives the opposite answer

A finding that has only been made in one market is a coincidence until it is tested somewhere else. So we ran the identical measurement on Raleigh. **"No incumbent" does not hold there — and that is what makes the Arizona number worth something.**

MEASURE	ARIZONA MULTIFAMILY	RALEIGH MULTIFAMILY
Projects with a confirmed architect	12	11
Distinct architecture firms	**11**	**7**
Largest single holder	Gensler, 2 projects	**JDAVIS, 4 projects**
Top firm's share	**17%**	**36%**
Firms per project	0.92	0.64

Raleigh's leading multifamily architect holds more than double the share Arizona's does, out of a field barely half as wide. Cline Design Associates is second with two. Five further firms — Perkins Eastman, Tightlines Design, Studio M, Foley Design and Iwan Architecture & Engineering Consultants — hold one each.

▲ AND THE INCUMBENT CHANGED HANDS FIFTEEN MONTHS AGO

JDAVIS was acquired by ISG on 14 May 2025. It is Raleigh-headquartered, 89 staff, and the acquirer is an employee-owned architecture and engineering firm expanding into the region. Every one of the four JDAVIS submittals recovered here was filed in 2024 — designed before that deal closed.

So the two markets ask opposite questions. In Arizona there is no share to take off anyone. **In Raleigh there is a clear leader, and it is fifteen months into an ownership change.**

✕ CHARLOTTE COULD NOT BE TESTED, AND WE WILL NOT PRETEND OTHERWISE

Three separate routes are closed. Charlotte's "Committed Development Entitlement" dataset — the richest schema we found anywhere — **stops at 23 May 2022**. Its live rezoning layer carries 86 pending petitions with a petitioner but **no project name and no design team**. And the city's own rezoning documents return **HTTP 403** to us, so the plan sets that would answer it cannot be read.

The Raleigh method would work on Charlotte the moment those documents are reachable. Today it does not, and a Charlotte number here would be invented.

THE QUESTION EVERYONE ASKS ABOUT ARIZONA

Design-build is taking the market — but not your part of it

Design-build is the standard worry about Phoenix, and it is a real one. It is also more precisely located than the worry usually is. Across the 50 projects, the architect and the contractor are **the same firm on six of them — twelve per cent**. Where those six sit is the whole story:

SECTOR	PROJECTS	DESIGN-BUILD	SHARE
Industrial / logistics	10	**5**	**50%**
Multifamily / residential	12	1	8%
Civic / education	17	0	0%
Healthcare	6	0	0%
Hospitality	5	0	0%

Half of Arizona industrial in this set is design-build. None of the civic, healthcare or hospitality work is, and one multifamily project out of twelve. Every single design-build project in the set belongs to one firm, LGE Design Build, and five of its six are industrial.

✕ AND ONE NAME THAT IS NOT WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Butler Design Group is not a design-build firm. It has six projects — joint-most in the set — and six different general contractors: Stevens-Leinweber, Ryan Companies on three, Willmeng and Layton. It is a conventional architecture practice whose name reads like a design-builder.

It is also **not a competitor for multifamily work**. Four of its six are industrial, one healthcare, one civic. **Zero residential.** Any read of the headline league table that treats the two six-project firms as the competitive pressure on a multifamily practice is wrong on both counts.

WHERE NOT TO SPEND THE CALL

Four developers that will not hire an outside architect

This falls out of the same data and is the part we would want if the positions were reversed. These are developers whose design work is structurally unavailable — not because they said no, but because of how they are built.

DEVELOPER	PROJECTS	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS
Creation Equity	**6** — the most active developer in the set	LGE Design Build on **all six**: five as design-builder, one as contractor alongside GFF Design. No outside architect appears on any Creation Equity project
Ryan Companies US	4	Developer *and* general contractor on all four, and it brings its own architect — Butler Design Group on three, Deutsch on the fourth
Statesman Group	1 (565,729 sf, six buildings)	Developer and contractor both. **No architect named at all**
StreetLights Residential	The Langley, 134 units	Fully vertically integrated: **StreetLights Creative Studio** is architect and interior designer, **SLR Construction** is the general contractor. Every seat in-house

The Butler–Ryan pairing is worth isolating: it is the **only architect-to-contractor relationship that repeats more than once** anywhere in the 50. Three projects together. Everything else in Arizona is a one-off pairing, which is another way of saying the same thing as the first section — this market has very few locked relationships.

THE THING YOU ASKED FOR

Phoenix submitted projects, from the city's own record

Phoenix publishes a live planning and permit service. It currently carries **68,292 permits and 13,022 plan reviews**, row-level, **current to the day this was run**. Filtered to site-plan and rezoning cases it returns **373 open cases**; filtered to those submitted since 1 January 2025, **280**; of which **41 are residential by project name**.

Among its eighty case types the one that matters most is **FINAL SITE PLAN – MAJOR**. That is the submittal whose drawing set carries the project directory sheet — every consultant, by discipline, with contact details. It is how a full design team gets confirmed from a city record rather than inferred from a press release.

SUBMITTED	CASE	PROJECT	ADDRESS	STAGE
12 May 2026	2602491	**Momentum Apartments**	734 E Vineyard Rd	Preliminary site plan
6 May 2026	2602468	**Senior Housing at 41st Ave**	2700 N 41st Ave	Preliminary site plan
21 Apr 2026	2602361	**17th St Apartments**	1634 E Wood St	Preliminary site plan
9 Apr 2026	2602015	Sagewood Phase 4 — residential & clubhouse	4400 E Palo Verde Dr	Preliminary site plan
1 Apr 2026	2601847	Virginia Townhome Project	4840 E Virginia Ave	Preliminary site plan
25 Feb 2026	2601066	Maryland Townhomes	742 E Maryland Ave	**Final site plan**
6 Feb 2026	2600890	Lion Foundation Housing	1415 E Wood St	Preliminary site plan
24 Dec 2025	2507260	**Deer Valley Apartments**	3010 W Deer Valley Dr	**Final site plan — major**
11 Dec 2025	2506990	34th & Thomas Apartment Homes	3425 E Thomas Rd	Preliminary site plan
9 Dec 2025	2506904	4th St Residences	4144 S 4th St	**Final site plan — major**
9 Dec 2025	2506899	Sierra Verde Townhomes	4800 S 16th St	**Final site plan — major**

Eleven of the forty-one, newest first. The full set travels with this document.

✕ TWO THINGS THIS LIST IS NOT

It is a snapshot, not a trend. Every row carries status OPEN, because closed cases leave the layer. Counting them by year would show 2024 smaller than 2025 and that would mean nothing — older cases have simply had longer to close. Anyone who hands you a submissions-per-year chart built from this feed has made that mistake.

And it does not name your architect competitor. The feed has a field called `PROFESS_NAME`, populated on 90.6% of plan reviews, and the name promises exactly that. Read the values and it is the licensed *contractor* — the most frequent entries are "TO BE BID", "OWNER", fire-sprinkler firms and solar installers. It is genuinely useful for who *builds* in Phoenix. It is not an architect and we will not present it as one.

Scottsdale is the instructive counter-example. Its case service is the cleanest we tested anywhere — 82 cases with all eight fields populated on all 82 rows, applicant included. And the newest submittal in it is **25 February 2026**, because the city moved to a new portal in January and the map only covers what came before. The live successor has a search API that requires an authentication token. **A perfect feed can still be a closed one**, and the only way to know which you are holding is to query it and look at the dates.

▲ ON THE TEST YOU SET US

You asked what happens to a 40-storey project filed that morning. **It is not in any public feed yet, and nobody's is.** It surfaces when the city posts the case or the trade press picks it up — typically days. The defensible claim is that nothing published gets missed. It is not that nothing unpublished is known, and we would rather say so than have you find out by testing it.

THE OTHER FIVE

What the layer holds in the rest of your markets

Same standard throughout: a firm appears against a project only where that firm's own page, the developer's own release, or the public record says so. Where the design team is incomplete the gap is shown rather than filled.

MARKET & PROJECT	DEVELOPER	ARCHITECT	CONTRACTOR
NEVADA · A's Ballpark, Las Vegas 33,000 seats, 2028	The Athletics	BIG + HNTB	Mortenson–McCarthy
NEVADA · Bally's Integrated Resort 26 ac, former Tropicana	Bally's Corp / JLL	Marnell Howryla	—
NEVADA · Silverado, Clark County 13.5 ac, heard 2 Sep 2026	Ochoa Development	Gensler + Yihong Liu	—
HAWAII · Kalae, Ward Village 330 homes	Howard Hughes / Victoria Ward	Solomon Cordwell Buenz	Layton
HAWAII · Ālia, Kaka'ako 457 units, 39 storeys	**Kobayashi Group**	WRNS Studio	—
HAWAII · Launiu, Ward Village 486 homes, 40 storeys	Howard Hughes	Arquitectonica	—
HOUSTON · The Lily River Oaks 38 storeys, 331 units	Southern Land Co.	Solomon Cordwell Buenz	ANDRES
HOUSTON · The Langley 20 storeys, 134 units	StreetLights + Hunt	StreetLights Creative Studio	SLR
DALLAS · Lucille, Uptown 22 storeys, 265 units	Endeavor Real Estate	HKS	Rogers-O'Brien
MIAMI · Waldorf Astoria 100 storeys, 360 residences	**PMG**	Sieger Suarez + Carlos Ott	—
MIAMI · Delano Residences 90 storeys	**PMG**	Carlos Ott · CUBE3 (AOR)	—
CHARLOTTE · Queensbridge Collective 755 units, $725M	Riverside + Woodfield + PGIM	Goettsch Partners	Clark
RALEIGH · Tributary, North Hills 332 units	Kane Realty	Hickok Cole	John Moriarty

Every architect above was read off the developer's own release, the architect's own project page, or the city record — never inferred. A dash means no public record names that role yet, which is not the same as the role being unfilled, and we would not present it as one.

Two developer names are worth isolating. *PMG* holds both Miami supertalls and used Carlos Ott on each, with CUBE3 carrying architect-of-record on the second — a developer running the same design relationship twice. *Kobayashi Group* is the counter-example: an independent Honolulu developer, sitting under Kamehameha Schools' Kaia'ulu 'o Kaka'ako master plan, which means **more towers behind it on the same landowner's ground**.

▲ ONE PATTERN WORTH YOUR ATTENTION

Solomon Cordwell Buenz is in two of your six markets — Kalae in Honolulu and The Lily River Oaks in Houston — on residential towers of 330 and 331 units respectively. Both confirmed from the developers' own releases. Whatever else the six markets have in common, one firm is already moving between them the way you are.

WHAT THIS CAN REACH

Three markets that looked closed are open, and current to today

Clark County, Dallas and Charlotte all publish nothing useful in their open-data feeds — each stopped in 2020, 2021 and 2022 respectively. They did not stop building. **They changed permitting systems, and all three moved to the same platform.** Their live records are public, and reachable without an account:

JURISDICTION	OLD FEED STOPPED	LIVE RECORD, VERIFIED
Clark County — the Strip	Feb 2021	**Current to the day queried**
Dallas	Mar 2020	**Current to the day queried**
Charlotte	May 2022	Aug 2026

Worked example. The Athletics ballpark on the former Tropicana site returns **79 county records**, March 2025 to August 2026 — precast packages, electrical, fire apparatus access, grading, phased building permits. That is the construction sequence of the largest project on the Strip, permit by permit, from the public record.

▲ THE EARLIEST SIGNAL A CITY HOLDS

Dallas has logged roughly **197 pre-development meetings in 2026** — the first formal contact a developer has with the city, *before* entitlement, before the design team is chosen, before any of it reaches the trade press. Eighty-nine are visible.

⚠ Being straight about it: those Dallas records carry a date, a number and a status, **but no project name and no address**. It is a measure of how busy the market is, not a list of leads. Clark County does name its projects and their status, so there the same query is genuinely actionable. **The value differs by city and we will always say which.**

WHERE THE WORK IS ACTUALLY MOVING

Raleigh's large multifamily flow quintupled. Las Vegas's did not move.

Counting permits above $10M — large enough that a scheme cannot inflate the number by filing each building separately — gives a read on how much serious multifamily work each market is actually releasing.

YEAR	LAS VEGAS (CITY)	RALEIGH
2022	3	6
2023	7	6
2024	4	3
2025	4	**15**
2026 (to late Aug)	5	7

Las Vegas has not changed in five years — three to seven large multifamily permits a year, every year, with 2026 running at or slightly above that. **Raleigh went from three in 2024 to fifteen in 2025**, and 2026 is tracking around eleven: off the peak, but still three to four times the 2022–24 baseline. If BD effort is being allocated across these two markets on the assumption they behave alike, they do not.

✕ THREE THINGS THAT WOULD MAKE THIS CHART LIE

Permit counts and permit values disagree, so we use both. On raw counts Raleigh 2026 looks like +151% over 2025. It is not: the permits are half the size they were — $7.2M average against $15.9M — because a scheme files per building. Total value rose about 15%. **Anyone quoting the count alone is quoting an artefact**, which is why the table above uses only permits large enough to be whole projects.

2026 is a part year and is never compared to a full one without saying so.

Las Vegas batch-issues. Every one of its 2026 multifamily permits was issued in a single week in June. A month-by-month version of this chart would show a spike that means nothing about the market.

▲ AND THE HONEST LIMIT ON THE NEVADA COLUMN

This is the **City of Las Vegas**. The Strip, Bally's, the Riviera site and the resort work are in **unincorporated Clark County**, a separate jurisdiction whose records do not carry a valuation field in the public search. **So the Nevada column understates Nevada**, and we would rather say that than quietly let the number stand for the state.

The comparison is deliberately *within* each city rather than between them. Cities classify differently, set different permit thresholds and cover different land areas — a raw count of Raleigh against Las Vegas would be a manufactured finding. Each column is that market measured against its own history, on that city's own classification: Las Vegas by its `MultiFam` work type, Raleigh by new-construction permits whose description states apartment or multifamily.

WHO ELSE IS DOING WHAT YOU ARE DOING

The firms operating across more than one of your markets

Most architecture practices are one-market businesses. The interesting ones are those serving many markets from a few offices — the same shape of firm, competing for the same work.

FIRM	WHERE WE FOUND THEM	SHAPE
Solomon Cordwell Buenz	**Houston** (The Lily River Oaks, 331 u) and **Honolulu** (Kalae, 330 u)	Two of your six, on near-identical residential towers. Both confirmed from the developers' own releases
Cline Design Associates	Raleigh (2 projects). Offices Raleigh, **Charlotte**, Austin, Washington DC	Calls itself a national design firm; multifamily, student and senior housing
Charlan Brock Architects	Raleigh (Livano North Hills, 280 u)	Florida-based, national multifamily and student housing since 1980
KTGY	Arizona (1 project)	Seven offices — Chicago, Denver, Irvine, LA, Oakland, Tysons, Pune. National multifamily, **no Southeast office**
Gensler	Arizona (3), and named on a Clark County scheme	Global, not multifamily-specialist
JDAVIS	Raleigh (4) — the local leader	Raleigh + Philadelphia, 89 staff. Acquired by ISG May 2025

The pattern is the point. None of these firms has an office in most of the markets it works in. KTGY covers the Southeast from seven offices, none of them in the Southeast. Cline reaches Texas and Washington from the Carolinas. **Serving many markets from few offices is not unusual in this business — it is the model the strongest multifamily practices already run.**

WHY THESE NUMBERS

What we did to keep this honest

Every figure above is either a query against a named public endpoint run on 27 August 2026, or a statement read off the named party's own page. Three habits produced the difference, and each came from getting something wrong first.

Counts reconcile against the source's own labels

The parser that read the 50 projects is checked against the document's own label count — 50 blocks against 50 `Address:`, 49 architects against 49 `Architect:`. An earlier parser silently under-reported and would have produced a tidier, wrong table. **A number that cannot be reconciled to its source is not reported.**

The primary source wins, every time

We checked trade-press figures against the party who has to be right about them. It disagreed four times out of four, and the primary source won each one.

"Could not read it" is not "it is not there"

Two pages we needed returned 403 and one portal requires an auth token. Those are recorded as blocked, never as absent. A negative finding has to be earned.

▲ WHERE A DESIGN TEAM ACTUALLY COMES FROM

No permit feed anywhere names an architect — not one of the fourteen tested. Every field that looks like it might is the *contractor*. The design team comes from two places instead, and both are public:

1. The drawing set. Cities that publish plan sets carry the project directory on the cover sheet, and the design firm's copyright block on every sheet. That is how the Raleigh figures in this document were built.

2. The contractor's own project page. The contractor is the one field populated in every permit feed, and contractors publish their projects with the design team attached. Livano North Hills is the example: no trade-press coverage names its architect, and its builder's project page names **Charlan Brock Architects** outright.

⚠ It is not a complete method — roughly one contractor page in three carries the team. But it converts the field that is always present into the field that never is, and it costs nothing.

FIGURE	TRADE PRESS	THE PARTY WHO HAS TO BE RIGHT
Ālia, Honolulu	477 units	**457** — WRNS Studio's own page, with a bedroom-by-bedroom breakdown
Waldorf Astoria, Miami	1,049 ft · 387 residences	**1,046 ft · 360 residences** — the project engineer's own page
Queensbridge, Charlotte	600,000 sf office	**356,000 sf**, 755 residential units — the developer's own page
Hylo Park, Las Vegas	700 units on 73 acres	**393 single-family homes** plus a lifestyle centre — the architect's own page

▲ HOW THE RALEIGH ARCHITECTS WERE OBTAINED

They are not in the permit feed, and they are not on the city's site-review application form — that form records the owner and the applicant, and the applicant is normally the civil engineer. The architect is in the **drawing set**, which Raleigh publishes: on the cover sheet's project directory, and stamped on every sheet in the design firm's copyright block.

So the chain runs **development-plan record → case number → published plan set → the firm named on the drawings**. Of **92** multifamily plans submitted since January 2024, **71** were published as the application form only, with no drawings. **21** came with a full drawing set. Of those 21, **12 name a building architect** and the remaining nine are civil or landscape submittals that name none — so the recovery is near-complete *on the sets that can answer*, which is what makes the percentages above safe to state.

One of the twelve was then removed: the firm captured was **Bass, Nixon & Kennedy**, picked up from the application's *Applicant* field. They are consulting engineers, not architects. Eleven remain.

✕ WHAT WE COULD NOT GET, STATED PLAINLY

Clark Construction's Queensbridge project page returns 403 and Scottsdale's live portal needs an authentication token, so both are blocked rather than empty. The structural engineer on the Waldorf Astoria is reported as CHM by secondary sources and is **not confirmed on that firm's own site**, which is why it carries a mark above. One further claim — a national engineer said to be on Queensbridge — failed verification against that firm's own project list and has been left out entirely rather than hedged.

Two of the six markets are covered project-by-project rather than statistically. **Only Arizona has a complete enough set to support the percentages in the first three sections**, and those percentages are not claimed for anywhere else.

KOR Structural — prepared for MVE + Partners, 27 August 2026. Every row count, date and percentage is reproducible from the endpoints named in the text.

Sources: AZ Big Media, *50 commercial real estate projects to know in 2026* · City of Phoenix Planning_Permit map service · City of Scottsdale Active_CDS_Cases · Hawaii Community Development Authority E